

replace the RAM with specifications similar to that of the other RAM.

SPD error

Q I have a Pentium III 800E processor on an Intel 815EEA2 motherboard, 128 MB PC100 RAM, nVidia Riva TNT2 M64 graphics card, and a Creative Vibra 128 soundcard handling the multimedia. I have Windows 98 SE running on my PC. I had a 48x CD-ROM, but recently I bought a 24x CD-RW. Of late, at the beginning of boot up, I get a message saying 'Serial Presence Detected (SPD) and essential data missing'. I think there is a problem with the motherboard. Can you resolve the problem?

Sundeep

Via e-mail

A There is no problem with the motherboard. It is just going through the normal detection routine. When it finds the RAM's SPD, it detects no information in it and hence you receive this error message. To avoid receiving this message, you should go to your BIOS and manually select the RAM timings there.

GAMING

Quake III unplayable with some mods

Q My PC's configuration is: Pentium II 300 MHz processor, a Riva TNT2 16 MB graphics card, 128 MB RAM and a 20 GB hard disk drive. I can play *Quake III* at 32 fps at 1024x768 smoothly with no crashes or problems. I can also play some mods such as *Capture the Chicken*, *Rune* and *Eternal* without any problems. But some of the mods such as *Alchemy*, *Avalanche* and *Head Hunters* refuse to work. Whenever I start them through the mods menu, the game restarts as usual but stops with a white screen and does not go further. If I bring the console down, it gives a

message saying, 'RERegisterFont: Free Type Code Not Available'. I have to quit the game using the command */quit*. The mod files are the latest and I have the latest *Quake III* patch 1.31 installed. Please help.

Jatin Kapadia

Via e-mail

A Try running the mods through the batch files that come with the mod and it should run fine without giving you any error. If you still receive this error, then the mod files do not comply with the latest *Quake III* point release. Hence, you will have to wait for a patch update.

Software

Outlook blocking e-mail

Q I recently upgraded to Office XP from Office 2000 Professional. My OS is Windows Me and I use IE 6.0. I use Outlook as my default mail manager. However, with Outlook XP, I find that it automatically blocks all attachments carrying .exe extensions while downloading mail from my mail server. Please tell me how I can turn this off



Tweak XP lets Outlook 2002 display e-mail attachments

as I already have Norton 2002's e-mail protection option activated.

Gourav Mahapatra

Via e-mail

A Microsoft Outlook 2002 by default blocks e-mail attachments, which have extensions such as .vbs, .exe, .com and others. This is done so as to prevent viruses—most of which come in these forms—from accessing your files and folders.

If you want Microsoft Outlook 2002 to display files with these extensions, you can do so by installing TweakXP. This utility has an

option that allows Microsoft Outlook 2002 to display such files.

Playing DVDs in Windows Media Player

Q I upgraded to Windows XP (Professional) on my laptop. I had heard that Windows Media Player bundled

with XP was supposed to play DVDs automatically. But I am unable to play DVDs using Windows Media Player or any other software. Do you have any solution for me?

Dilip D'souza

Via e-mail

A To enable Windows Media Player to play DVDs you have to apply a special patch available at www.microsoft.com. You can even enable Windows Media Player by installing Customiser XP, a third-party tweak utility.

You can also buy a DVD player software such as Cyberlink Power DVD.

Damaged log files

Q Whenever I start or shut down my PC, I get the error message: 'TASKMON caused an invalid page fault in module KERNEL32.DLL.' Please help me.

S. Gopal

Via e-mail

A The Task Monitor tool that is included with Windows 98 and Windows Me records the disk-access patterns of programs when they are started. Task Monitor stores this information in log files in the Applog folder. Task Monitor also records the number of times you use a program. The error you are getting is because the log files in the Windows\Applog folder are damaged. When you shut down Windows 98 or Windows Me, the Task Monitor tool attempts to update these log files and the failure to do so gives this message. To resolve this problem, follow these steps: Double-click the My Computer

icon on the desktop and then double-click the drive that contains the Windows folder. On the View menu, click Folder Options and then click the View tab. Under the Hidden Files section, click Show All Files and click OK. Now double-click the Windows folder, right-click the Applog folder, click Rename,

type a new name for the folder (such as Applog2), and

then press [Enter]. Restart your computer. The Applog folder and log files are re-created automatically. Now you should not receive this error.

